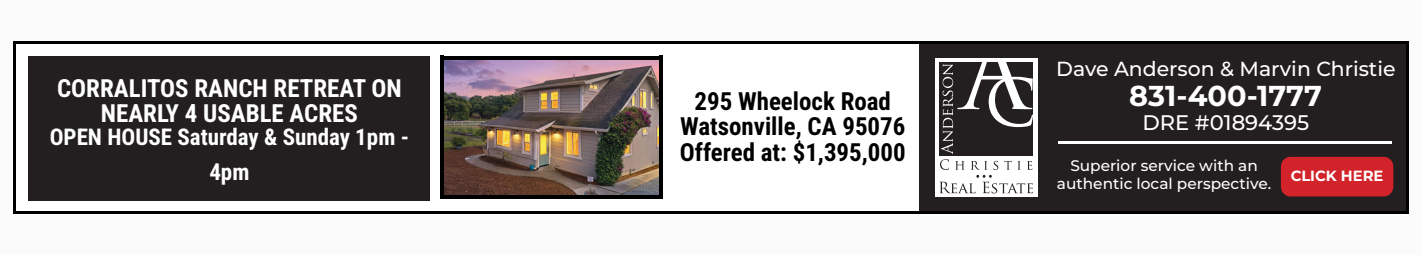
Dave Anderson & Marvin Christie
831-400-1777
DRE #01894395
CLICK HERE



CORRALITOS RANCH RETREAT ON NEARLY 4 USABLE ACRES
OPEN HOUSE Saturday & Sunday 1pm - 4pm
295 Wheelock Road
Watsonville, CA 95076
Offered at: $1,395,000
Dave Anderson & Marvin Christie
831-400-1777
DRE #01894395
Superior service with an authentic local perspective.
CLICK HERE

Editorial | About the Santa Cruz city workers' strike and rising discontent

By **EDITORIAL BOARD** | editorial@santacruzsentinel.com | Santa Cruz Sentinel
PUBLISHED: October 19, 2022 at 5:00 AM PDT | UPDATED: October 19, 2022 at 6:20 AM PDT

Listen to this article now
Powered by Trinity Audio
00:00 04:12 1.0x

Many residents of the city of Santa Cruz might be wondering about why they are having to suffer more hardships when they can barely afford to live here in the first place?

As of this writing, a strike by city employees is affecting Santa Cruzans in ways that probably just add to their frustration.

Having to deal with the high cost of living alongside the added pressures of inflation, while encountering seemingly unsolvable problems such as homeless encampments and a critical housing shortage, is a recipe for even more discontent as the Nov. 8 election is underway (mail-in ballots are already being submitted).

But all the things that are making October 2022 a time of uneasiness also underlie the demands by striking municipal workers.

And more.

Strikes are up around the country, as workers and labor leaders, in both public and in private industry, say they are angry with employers for failing to raise pay and by the lack of high-quality jobs, or, in the case of Santa Cruz, about jobs that remain unfilled. They also are frustrated that wage growth is not keeping pace with rampant inflation.

In this strike, the Service Employees International Union, Local 521, has filed three unfair labor practice complaints against the City of Santa Cruz. The union represents about 420 city workers, who have walked off their jobs, and it marks the first full-length strike by SEIU employees in the city's history.

One of the main sticking points has been staffing vacancies that include job turnovers that workers say have negatively impacted all city departments. Many of these positions went vacant during the pandemic; others have gone dark because of city belt tightening due to budget shortfalls.

While many residents support union workers – and the two candidates for Santa Cruz mayor, SEIU-endorsed Fred Keeley and Joy Schendledecker, were out on the picket lines Monday – their patience will be sorely tried should the walkout continue for long. The impacts of the strike, as of this writing, are wide ranging: With no union workers on the job, there will be no city trash pickup this week, public bathrooms and gated parks will be locked, City Hall permit and bill-paying counters will remain closed and – in the only good news for residents – parking tickets will not be issued.

City libraries will stay closed throughout the strike. Parks and rec facilities will also be closed, which will mean many youth sports activities will be canceled for the duration.

Many residents were probably surprised by this labor action, since SEIU 521 had called off plans for a strike earlier this month when negotiators came to a tentative agreement with the city that included a 12% pay raise and a one-time bonus.

But that was before 80% of the union membership voted against the proposed settlement. Many members say they don't trust the city to make good on promises, which, they say, have proven flimsy in recent years.

The city is using an outside state mediator in the new round of negotiations with the SEIU, whose leaders say that if and when another tentative settlement is reached, the union will continue the strike until the agreement is ratified. The mediator has been acting as a go-between for both sides and will continue to seek a settlement as long as it takes, according to the SEIU and the city.

Of course, in addition to rebuilding a modicum of trust between the workforce and city administrators, any settlement is going to take resources put into workforce compensation and filling vacant positions. Budget cuts in recent years have been painful and one of the ways the city has reconciled deficits is to keep vacant positions unfilled, which can mean added job duties, without added compensation, for rank and file employees.

There's no painless solution to issues that have been building up for several years. City taxpayers won't want to see services further degraded, or taxes raised further, so we'll be intrigued to hear how the city says it will afford an equitable settlement.

CORRALITOS RANCH RETREAT ON NEARLY 4 USABLE ACRES
OPEN HOUSE Saturday & Sunday 1pm - 4pm
295 Wheelock Road, Watsonville, CA 95076
Offered at: $1,395,000
Dave Anderson & Marvin Christie
831-400-1777
info@andersonchristie.com
www.andersonchristie.com
DRE #01894395
Superior service with an authentic local perspective.
CLICK HERE

JUST SOLD FOR $6,050,000 WITH MULTIPLE OFFERS!
1122 WEST CLIFF DRIVE JUST ACHIEVED ONE OF THE HIGHEST SALES ALONG SANTA CRUZ'S COASTLINE. INVENTORY REMAINS LIMITED — AND I MAY ALREADY HAVE A BUYER FOR YOUR HOME. CURIOUS WHAT YOUR HOME COULD SELL FOR? LET'S CONNECT.
MARCELA SIMONKOVA 831.430.8819
REALTOR® DRE 02108736
marcela@davidlyng.com | marcelasimonkova.com
DAVID LYNG REAL ESTATE
Click Here

RECOMMENDED FOR YOU

1 10 unique global hotels that are perfect for stargazing
2 Music lovers scramble to save Santa Cruz's Catalyst Club
3 Focal Point | View of Soquel Creek in Capitola in 1940s
4 Photo | Ready to roll at Boardwalk Bowl in Santa Cruz
5 Capitola Cliff Jumps will be flattened in coming days
6 Ups, downs of downtown Santa Cruz economy | Ross Eric Gibson, Local History
7 Editorial | Reelect Golder, Newsome to Santa Cruz City Council
8 Santa Clara County targets healthcare, jobs in sweeping cuts to close $787 million deficit
9 Photo | Moon rises through cloudbank above Santa Cruz
10 Robotaxis can break traffic laws without fines under new California rules

JUST SOLD FOR $6,050,000 WITH MULTIPLE OFFERS!
1122 WEST CLIFF DRIVE JUST ACHIEVED ONE OF THE HIGHEST SALES ALONG SANTA CRUZ'S COASTLINE. INVENTORY REMAINS LIMITED — AND I MAY ALREADY HAVE A BUYER FOR YOUR HOME. CURIOUS WHAT YOUR HOME COULD SELL FOR? LET'S CONNECT.
MARCELA SIMONKOVA 831.430.8819
REALTOR® DRE 02108736
marcela@davidlyng.com | marcelasimonkova.com
DAVID LYNG REAL ESTATE
Click Here

Around the Web REVCONTENT

Surgeons: This Simple Method Will End Joint Pain & Arthritis (Try It)
Health Headlines

Endocrinologists: If You Have Diabetes, Read This Before It's Removed!
Health Headlines

Dementia and Memory Loss Have Been Linked to a Common Habit. Do You Do It?
Health Headlines

Sciatica is Not From a Slipped Disc. Meet The Real Enemy of Sciatica (Stop This)
SmoothSpine

Never Throw Empty Ketchup Bottles, Do This Instead
WellnessPeek

A Man Picked Up a Kitten on The Street, but This is What Grew Up!
Buzzday

Always Wrap Your Car Keys in Aluminum Foil, Here's Why
LifeHack Guru

Surgeon Reveals: This Simple Trick Will End Joint Pain & Arthritis! (Try It)
Health Headlines

If You Have Diabetes, Read This Before It's Removed!
Health Headlines

Neurologists: 2 Common Foods Linked to Dementia Risk. Are You Eating Them?
Health Headlines

Odd Power Invention Rips Up Power Bills (It Saved Me So Much Money)
Home Energy Review

Heartfelt Moment As Wolf Enters Hospital – Nurse's Emotional Response
Buzzday

Greta Thunberg's House Shocks The Whole World, The Proof in pics
Stars Are Made

Boat Missing for 20 Years Reappears: What Fishermen Found Inside!
Buzzday

Surgeons: This Simple Trick Will End Knee Pain & Arthritis Quickly (Try It)
Health Headlines

Flip Your Peanut Butter Jar Before Storing It - It's Genius
WellnessPeek

Shooting Pain Down Your Leg? This 12-Minute Method Relieves It
RejuvaCare

Man Saves a Dolphin Calf, What Happened Next Was Incredible
Buzzday

Dementia and Memory Loss Have Been Linked to a Common Food. Are You Eating It?
Health Headlines

Is Your Cat Showing Its Tummy? Here's What It Really Means!
Buzzday

Man Hears Elephant's Cry! Then Sees What No One Expected
Buzzday

Meet The Pillow That Changes Sleep Apnea Sufferers Lives, It's Genius!
Smarter Living

The Iceberg Floated Near a Village. All The Residents Turned Pale
Buzzday

Surgeons: This Simple Method Will End Knee Pain & Arthritis (Try It)
Health Headlines

Tom Cruise's Daughter Was a Beautiful Child, Look at her now
Your Health Agent

Mix Some Salt and Vaseline (Here's Why)
LifeHacks Insider

Why Nails Become Ridged: a Vital Sign
Buzzday

Jaw-Dropping: The Elephant's Surprise After 11 Hours of Digging
Buzzday

What Does It Mean When Someone Puts a Plastic Bottle on Your Tire
Buzzday

Sleep Apnea is Linked to This Household Item (Stop Using It)
Wellness Wire Daily

After 60, Leg Strength Comes From One Simple Daily Move
ApexLabs

Arthritis or Joint Pain? Do This Immediately (Watch Results in 4 Days)
Healthier Living Tips

This is Who Really Makes Costco's Kirkland Items
learnitwise

Men Enter Abandoned Cruise Ship: When They Uncover What's Inside Call The Police
Buzzday

Discover The Hidden Gem They Didn't See
Buzzday

Confirmed - This is The Deadliest Snake in The World
novelodge

Hoda Kotb Steps Out With Her Partner And Fans Are Stunned
Vetob

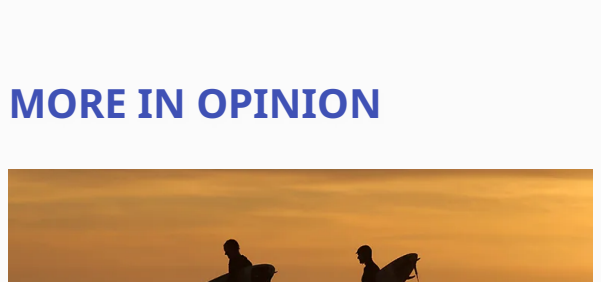
Taking Metformin? Use This Household Food to Lower Blood Sugar
WellnessGaze Diabetes

Shocking Discovery: This Daily Habit Stops Gum Disease in Its Tracks
WellnessGaze Dental

Create Unique Math Cheat Sheets for Free. Simple, Quick, and Effective!
CheatSheeting

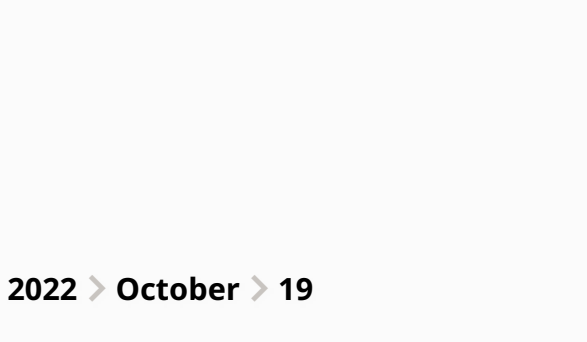
Hair Loss? It's Not Your Stress, Diet or Even Genetics. Watch This Video
WG Hair Restore

¿vale La Pena El Lexus Lx 700h 2025?
Autoproyecto



SPONSORED CONTENT
New Listing - 9185 Vista Ct, 95650
By Back At You

MORE IN OPINION



Editorial | Reelect Golder, Newsome to Santa Cruz City Council

Ups, downs of downtown Santa Cruz economy | Ross Eric Gibson, Local History

Letters to the Editor | May 2, 2026

Commentary | Talkin' 'bout my generation

2022 > October > 19

Santa Cruz Sentinel

SUBSCRIBE
e-Edition
Sign Up For Newsletters

CONTACT US
Digital Access FAQ
Work With Us
Privacy Policy
Accessibility
Sitemap

ADVERTISE WITH US
MediaNews Group Advertising
Today's Ads

CLASSIFIEDS
Public Notices
Submit an Obituary
Local Guide
Mid Coast Jobs
Real Estate

ONLINE CUSTOMER SERVICE
Reprints
Get Sponsored Access
Sponsor A Group

SUBSCRIBE NOW

Terms of Use Cookie Policy Cookie Preferences California Notice at Collection Notice of Financial Incentive Do Not Sell/Share My Personal Information Arbitration Powered by WordPress.com VIP

Copyright 2026 Santa Cruz Sentinel. All rights reserved. The use of any content on this website for the purpose of training artificial intelligence systems, algorithms, machine learning models, text and data mining, or similar use is strictly prohibited without explicit written consent.